TABLETOP ROLEPLAYING

Hexcraft

Player's Guide

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Welcome to Hexcraft

Hexcraft is a point-buy tabletop RPG with one rule at its heart: **roll a d20, add what you're good at, beat the number.**

One player runs the world as the **GM**; everyone else plays a single character. The GM describes situations and decides when a roll is needed. You describe what your character does and roll when asked.

There are **no levels and no classes**. Everything your character can do is bought with **Build Points (BP)**: attributes, skills, hit points, energy, magic and even movement speed all come out of the same budget. Want a sword-swinging healer who talks her way past guards? Buy exactly that.

As the campaign goes on, the GM awards bonus BP and you spend it on whatever you want to grow next.

> **At the table you need:** a d20, a few d6/d8/d10 for damage and armor, and your character sheet. Build and track your character at **rpg.jaeg.click**, which does all the arithmetic in this guide for you.

Building a Character

1. Pick a power tier

The table picks a tier together. It sets everyone's starting BP. A first campaign usually starts at **New Adventurers** or **Guild Regulars**. The tier is locked once play begins; characters grow through BP awards instead.

TIER	STARTING BP
Peasants	150
Soldiers	300
New Adventurers	400
Guild Regulars	550
Proven Hand	700
Guild Veteran	900
Guild Elite	1,100
National Elite	1,400
World Savior	2,000

2. Take tethers and flaws (optional)

Tethers and flaws **give you extra BP** up front in exchange for story hooks and drawbacks. See *Tethers & Flaws*.

3. Spend your BP

- **Attributes**: Power, Agility, Intelligence, Sense, Influence
- **Hit Points (HP)**: 2 BP per 3 HP
- **Energy Points (EP)**: 2 BP per EP. EP fuels spells
- **Speed**: 20 ft by default, bought up (or sold down) in 5 ft steps
- **Skills**: the combat skills, the three saves, and any skill you can describe
- **Magic**: spell schools and mediums, if your character casts

You can't spend more than your budget, and you must meet the GM's obligation threshold for tethers.

Cost table

Every cost in Hexcraft climbs on the same curve. Each column is the **total** BP to reach that level from 0. Attributes and speed can also go **below zero** to refund the same amounts.

LEVEL	SKILL	ATTRIBUTE / SCHOOL	MEDIUM	SPEED
1	2	13	8	25 ft
2	5	34	21	30 ft
3	10	68	42	35 ft
4	18	123	76	40 ft
5	31	212	131	45 ft
6	52	356	220	50 ft
7	86	730	364	55 ft
8	141	1,248	738	60 ft

Speed levels count 5 ft steps above 20 ft: 25 ft is level 1, 30 ft level 2, and so on. 15 ft refunds 13 BP.

> **Example: Mira, a New Adventurers ranger (400 BP).** She takes *Hunted by the Black Sigil* (Major tether, +15 BP) and *Trust no priest* (Flaw, +15 BP), giving her 430 BP. She buys Agility +3 (68), Power +1 (13), Sense +2 (34), 18 HP (12) and 10 EP (20), and spends the rest on skills, weapons and a saved spell.

Attributes & Skills

Attributes

ATTRIBUTE	COVERS
Power	Strength, force, two-handed weapons, tackling
Agility	Speed, balance, one-handed weapons, grappling, Evasion
Intelligence	Reasoning, study, memory
Sense	Perception, intuition, awareness
Influence	Presence, persuasion, force of personality

Skills

A skill is anything your character is trained in, named however you like: *Lockpicking*, *Court etiquette*, *Long-range rifle manufacturing*. Narrow skills are cheap to be great at; broad skills help more often but less (see *Making a Roll*).

A skill can also have an optional **specificity**: what exactly it is good at. *Animal Handling* with the specificity *Dogs*, *Driving* with *Motorcycle*. A task that matches the specificity is the skill's best fit; the same skill can be taken more than once with different specificities.

Every character also has these **combat skills**, bought like any other skill:

SKILL	TYPE	EFFECT	ATTRIBUTE
Dodge	Passive	+1 Evasion per level; save vs. agility-based effects	—
Grit	Passive	Save vs. physical effects	—
Resolve	Passive	Save vs. mental effects	—
Parry	Reaction	−1 to an incoming attack per level	—
1-handed melee	Action	Attack bonus with 1H melee weapons	Agility
1-handed fired	Action	Attack bonus with 1H fired weapons	Agility
2-handed melee	Action	Attack bonus with 2H melee weapons	Power
2-handed fired	Action	Attack bonus with 2H fired weapons	Power
Unarmed	Action	Attack bonus with fists or natural weapons (claws, horns, bite)	Agility
Grapple	Action	Attack bonus to seize and hold	Agility
Tackle	Action	Attack bonus to knock down or drive back	Power

Each spell school you know also counts as a skill at the school's level, listed on your sheet by its discipline: Destruction, Creation, Alteration, Restoration, Divination, Control or Summoning Magic.

Tethers & Flaws

Tethers are the relationships and duties that pull your character through the world: a sworn oath, a child to protect, a cult that wants you dead. **Flaws** are personal failings, physical, mental or social. The test: a tether is something your character owes, has been charged with, or can't escape; something they merely want, however badly, is a flaw.

TETHER	BP REFUND	OBLIGATION WEIGHT
Minor	+5	1
Major	+15	2
Binding	+40	3

FLAW	BP REFUND
Quirk	+5
Flaw	+15
Vice	+40

The GM sets an **obligation threshold**: your tethers' weights must add up to at least that number. Flaws carry no weight.

TETHER	TYPICAL OBLIGATIONS
Minor	Defense of another, Debt, Financial support
Major	Sworn oath, Bounty on head, Life debt, Territorial claim
Binding	Blood oath, God's orders, Geas, Hostage

Binding covers anything that binds your life, or someone else's, to obedience. A *geas* is a supernatural command or taboo whose breaking brings ruin.

Tether examples

TETHER	EXAMPLE	HOW IT BITES
Minor Defense of another	*Must protect his younger sister, Wren.*	Wren sends for him when she is in trouble, and anyone who wants leverage over him goes after her.
Major Sworn oath	*Sworn to the Lantern Watch.*	The order sends orders and expects them followed, even mid-quest. Ignoring a summons costs rank, pay and allies inside the Watch.
Binding Hostage	*The Duke holds his mother.*	He does the Duke's work when the Duke asks, whatever it is, or she dies. There is no walking away while she is held.

This is a contract. When a tether or flaw costs you time, money, allies or HP, it's working as intended. If yours never come up, expect the GM to bring them in.

For the GM: setting the threshold. If you're not sure what obligation threshold to set, start at **3**. That all but guarantees every character carries obligations that matter, and that their choices will run into them.

When a player turns their back on an obligation, make it cost them. If they abandon an alliance, the people they were allied with should strike back at the most opportune moment. The consequences should land within **one or two sessions**, while the choice is still fresh.

Making a Roll

d20 + attribute + skill vs DC

The GM picks the **attribute** that fits what you're doing. You say which of your **skills** you're using for it. The GM decides how relevant that skill is and sets the **DC** from there.

DIFFICULTY	DC
Easy	12
Medium	20
Hard	30
Near-impossible	40

How well does your skill fit?

The GM starts from the task's difficulty, then adjusts it for how closely your skill matches. Round down.

FIT	CHANGE	MEANING	SNIPER RIFLE (HARD, DC 30)
Negative	× 1.5	Your training points the wrong way	Cooking: **DC 45**
None	unchanged	No skill applies	No skill: **DC 30**
Relevant	× 0.90	A broad skill that touches the domain	Firearms knowledge: **DC 27**
Adjacent	× 0.75	A skill in the same neighborhood	Firearms manufacturing: **DC 22**
Exact	× 0.60	Precisely what you trained for	Long-range rifle making: **DC 18**

Natural rolls and criticals

- **Natural 20**: +10 to the total. **Natural 1**: −10. Neither succeeds or fails on its own; the total still has to beat the DC.
- **Critical success**: beat the DC by 10 or more. On an attack, that's a critical hit.
- **Critical failure**: total below 25% of the DC. Something goes badly wrong.

Saving Throws

There are exactly three saves, each a combat skill you buy:

SAVE	WHAT IT IS	FOR EXAMPLE
Dodge	Avoiding	Leaping clear, dodging traps, weaving through fire
Grit	Powering through	Shaking off poison, withstanding a knockdown, enduring pain
Resolve	Mental resistance	Resisting charm, mental intrusion, illusions, fear

d20 + save level (+ attribute if it fits) vs DC

A spell's save DC is **10 + the caster's school + medium**.

> **Example.** A spider mage (school 3, medium 3) casts a charm at Mira: Resolve DC 16. Mira has Resolve 2, rolls d20 + 2 and gets 17. She resists.

Combat

Turns & actions

Combat runs in turns. You have **4 actions**, and they reset to 4 at the **end of your turn**.

- **On your turn**, spend actions on whatever you do: attack, move up to your speed, cast a spell or use a maneuver (one with a timing of *Action* takes 1 action, *2 Actions* takes 2, *1 Round* takes all 4), draw a weapon, open a door.
- **Between your turns**, the actions you hold are your **reactions**. When any combatant takes an action, you may react to it by spending one of your actions. You can react once per turn, meaning once during each other combatant's turn, so over a round you can react as many times as you have actions for.
- **Whatever you spend reacting comes out of your next turn.** React twice and you start your turn with 2 actions.

DEFAULT REACTION	WHEN	EFFECT
Parry	You're adjacent to a combatant who attacks	−1 to that attack per level of Parry
Move	Any action by any combatant	Move up to your speed

A spell or maneuver with a timing of *Reaction* is cast as a reaction, in response to someone else's action.

> **Example.** Mira ends her turn and her actions reset to 4. On the bandit's turn he swings at the ally beside her, and she Parries (1 action). On the next bandit's turn he steps toward her, and she moves out of reach (1 action). Her turn comes with 2 actions: she attacks twice. At the end of it she's back to 4.

Attacking

d20 + weapon skill + attribute vs Evasion

Evasion = 10 + Agility + Dodge − armor penalties

On a hit, roll the weapon's damage (for example a shortsword: 1d6 Physical). The GM may add damage types for the situation: a torch deals Fire.

Natural weapons. Claws, horns, a bite or a tail are weapons that are part of you. Add one to your inventory with the category *Natural (Unarmed)*, its damage in the notes (for example claws: 1d6 Physical). It attacks with the Unarmed skill plus your choice of **Agility** (quick claws, a snapping bite) or **Power** (goring horns, a crushing tail), picked per weapon. It can't be dropped or disarmed, and sits beside your plain fists in your attacks.

> **Example.** A bandit with 1-handed melee +3 and Power +2 swings at Mira (Evasion 14): d20 + 5, rolls 13, total 18. Hit, 1d6 + 2 Physical.

Damage types

All damage has a type: Physical, Fire, Cold, Lightning, Acid, Poison, Psychic, Magical, Force, Sonic.

Armor

CLASS	REDUCTION DIE	THRESHOLD	DURABILITY	EVASION PENALTY
Light	d6	10	12	−2
Medium	d8	12	15	−4
Heavy	d10	15	20	−6

Each piece of armor protects against the damage types listed on it. Armor can be made Lightweight or Heavyweight (±1 to ±3 Evasion penalty), Durable or Brittle (±2 to ±6 threshold and durability), and more protective (+1 to +3 flat reduction).

Taking damage

1. Find each equipped armor piece that covers the damage type and roll its reduction die. Add them up.
2. Subtract that from the damage. Temporary HP absorbs the rest first, then your HP.
3. If the damage was **greater than** a matching armor's threshold, that armor loses **damage ÷ threshold** durability (round down). At 0 it breaks and comes off.

> **Example.** Mira's hardened leather coat (Light: d6, threshold 10, durability 12) takes a 23 Physical hit. She rolls a 4: 19 damage to HP. 23 is over 10, so the coat loses 2 durability (now 10).

Damage your armor doesn't cover goes straight through. Steel won't stop fire or psychic attacks.

Dropping to 0 HP

At 0 HP you're down and rolling **death saves** as the GM directs. **Three successes**: you're stable (unconscious, no longer dying). **Three failures**: you die. While dying you can **spend all your remaining EP** to get back up at 1 HP.

A **long rest** heals **1d6 HP** and recovers **1d4−1 EP** for every hour you sleep, up to your maximums. It clears temporary HP and death saves.

Magic

Every spell needs a **school** (what it does) and a **medium** (what it acts on). You must have trained both.

Schools

Destroy, Create, Alter, Restore, Divine, Control, Summon

School costs follow the Attribute / School column of the cost table; medium costs follow the Medium column.

Mediums

MEDIUM	ACTS ON
Elemental	Fire, water, earth, lightning, air, sound.
Magic	Counterspelling and effects that target magic itself.
Kinetic	Manipulates speed and motion.
Cognition	Charm, persuasion, and effects influencing thoughts or actions.
Space	Teleportation and spatial manipulation.
Toxicity	Poisons and acids.
Material	Targets a specific item or person: alter self, locate object, etc.
Vitality	Healing, life force, and biological vigor.

Resolving a spell

- **Roll to hit**: d20 + school + medium vs the target's Evasion.
- **Save**: the target makes a Dodge, Grit or Resolve save against DC 10 + school + medium.

Amping

Spend an extra **5 EP** as you cast to add +1 to the hit bonus or the save DC. Repeat as many times as you can afford.

Saved spells

You can save (prepare) as many spells per school as your level in that school. A saved spell costs **25% less EP** to cast.

Building a Spell

You build every spell from parts. Pick one option for each criterion, add damage dice, then pick a casting time.

EP = (criteria + 2 per damage die) × casting-time multiplier, rounded up

Range · 4 EP per tier

OPTION	TIER	EP
touch / 30 ft	0	0
120 ft	1	4
600 ft	2	8
1 mile	3	12
any distance	4	16
cross-planar	5	20

Challenge · 8 EP per tier

OPTION	TIER	EP
none / 150 BP	0	0
400 BP	1	8
1,000 BP	2	16
2,500 BP	3	24
5,000 BP	4	32
10,000 BP	5	40

Challenge is how strong a target the spell can overcome, measured in that target's BP.

Casting time

TIME	MULTIPLIER
Reaction	× 4
Action	× 2
2 Actions	× 1
1 Round	× 0.75
1 Minute	× 0.5
1 Hour	× 0.25

Damage dice

2 EP per die.

AOE / Targets · 5 EP per tier

TARGETED

OPTION	TIER	EP
none / self	0	0
single target	0	0
split damage	1	5
3 targets	2	10
10 targets	3	15
100 targets	5	25

SPLASH

OPTION	TIER	EP
20 ft	1	5
60 ft	2	10
120 ft	3	15
300 ft	4	20

LINE

OPTION	TIER	EP
60 ft	1	5
300 ft	2	10
600 ft	3	15
1 mile	4	20

Duration · 4 EP per tier

Concentration: a spell that lasts beyond an instant needs concentration if it covers an **area** (a splash or a line), has **damage or healing dice**, or has a Buff/Debuff marked **(C)**. So an area spell is either instantaneous or concentration. The split follows D&D 5e's nearest spells, except that every granted sense needs concentration: Charm Person or Tongues need none, while darkvision, Enhance Ability (+skill), Hold Person (debilitated) or Slow do. You don't choose: the spell builder offers only the list that applies.

NO CONCENTRATION

OPTION	TIER	EP
instantaneous	0	0
1 minute	1	4
1 hour	2	8
1 day	3	12
1 year	4	16
permanent	5	20

CONCENTRATION

OPTION	TIER	EP
1 round	1	4
1 minute	2	8
1 hour	3	12
8 hours	4	16

Buff / Debuff · 5 EP per tier

TIER	EP	EFFECTS
I	5	darkvision (C), magic detection (C), languages, 1-sense illusions, +2 skill (C), cursory knowledge, inconvenience (C), poisoned (C), deafened, grappled (C), slowed (C), reincarnation
II	10	tremorsense (C), see invisibility (C), detect lies (C), multi-sense illusions (C), +5 skill (C), fundamental knowledge, prone, frightened (C), illness, undeath, exhaustion (C)
III	15	truesight (C), total evasion (C), detailed knowledge, disability (C), restrained (C), blinded, silenced (C), charmed, resurrection
IV	20	debilitated (C), banished (C), dominated (C), polymorphed (C), total knowledge, true resurrection
V	25	soul-bound, death, True Resurrection (greater)

(C) needs concentration unless instantaneous.

> **Example: Cinder Lance.** Devon (Destroy 3, Elemental 3) builds a single-target, 120 ft fire bolt doing 4d6, resolved as a hit roll and cast in 2 actions. Range 120 ft is 4 EP; four damage dice are 8 EP. Base cost **12 EP**; saved, **9 EP**. His hit bonus is +6; for 5 more EP (14 total) he can push it to +7.

Maneuvers

Maneuvers are the martial side of the same system: signature strikes, sweeps, trips, disarms and feints. You build one the way you build a spell and pay for it in EP, but from a shorter list of parts:

- **Range** and **AOE / targets**: the same options and EP as spells.
- **Duration**: instantaneous, 1 round or 1 minute. There's no concentration.
- **Effect**: non-magical effects only, listed below. There's no Challenge.
- **Extra damage**: d6s added to the weapon's own damage, 2 EP per die.
- **Self-debuff** (optional): a drawback you take on to pay for the move, which **takes EP off** its cost.
- **Timing**: the same multipliers as a spell's casting time.

Duration · 4 EP per tier

OPTION	TIER	EP
instantaneous	0	0
1 round	1	4
1 minute	2	8

Effect · 5 EP per tier

TIER	EP	EFFECTS
I	5	advantage on attack, +2 to a check, push 10 ft, disarmed, grappled, slowed
II	10	damage resistance, sneak attack, +5 to a check, prone, frightened, bleeding
III	15	extra action, restrained, blinded
IV	20	debilitated

Self-debuffs

Going all in has a price. A self-debuff refunds 5 EP per tier, and the longer it lasts the more it refunds (4 EP per tier of its own duration). The refund comes off before the timing multiplier, and a maneuver never costs less than 0.

TIER	REFUND	SELF-DEBUFFS
I	−5	rooted, exposed, off-balance
II	−10	poisoned, burned, prone, exhaustion
III	−15	blinded, restrained
IV	−20	debilitated

LASTS	TIER	REFUND
1 round	0	0
1 minute	1	−4
1 hour	2	−8
until a long rest	3	−12

Instead of a school and a medium, a maneuver draws on one of your **attack combat skills** (1-handed melee, 2-handed fired, Unarmed, Grapple, Tackle and so on) and that skill's attribute.

- **Roll to hit**: d20 + combat skill + attribute vs the target's Evasion.
- **Save**: the target saves against DC 10 + combat skill + attribute.

- **Signature moves**: save as many maneuvers per combat skill as your level in it. A saved maneuver costs 25% less EP.
- **Amping** works the same: 5 more EP for +1 to hit or +1 DC.

> **Example: Hamstring.** Mira (1-handed melee 3, Agility 3) builds a two-action cut at a single target within reach that leaves it *slowed* for 1 minute and deals her sword's damage +1d6. Slowed is a Tier I effect (5 EP), 1 minute is duration tier 2 (8 EP) and the extra die is 2 EP: **15 EP**, or **11 EP** saved. She rolls d20 + 6 against the target's Evasion.

> **Example: Reckless Strike.** Mira throws everything into one blow: advantage on the attack (5 EP) and +4d6 (8 EP), 13 EP. She plants her feet to do it and is *rooted* (−5 EP) for 1 minute (−4 EP), bringing it down to **4 EP**.

Conditions

What the conditions mean when a spell, a maneuver or a self-debuff puts them on someone.

CONDITION	EFFECT
Exposed	Anything attacking you has +5.
Off-balance	Your movement speed is halved, and you add no bonuses to the rolls you make.
Rooted	Your movement speed is 0.
Poisoned	You take 1d6 poison damage each round.
Burned	You take 1d6 fire damage each round.
Prone	You fall over.
Exhaustion	Per level: your HP, EP and movement speed maximums drop by 10, and all your skills, attributes and saving throws drop by 2.
Blinded	You can't see.
Restrained	You are off-balance, rooted and exposed.
Debilitated	You are restrained, and you can't take actions.
Slowed	Your movement speed is halved.
Grappled	Your movement speed is 5 ft, and you have −5 to attack rolls.
Frightened	You can't move toward the source, attack it, or cast spells targeting it.
Bleeding	You lose 1d6 HP each round.
Charmed	You're under the effects of Cognition magic.

Growing Your Character

The GM awards bonus BP at meaningful moments: surviving a session, finishing a quest beat, uncovering a secret. The usual pace is **5–25 BP per session**. That's enough to grow steadily over a campaign; no single session is a level-up.

Add awarded BP in the builder's **BP Management** step, then spend it anywhere in your build. Your power tier never changes.

For the GM

The **Tools** page on the site has a DC calculator for the fit arithmetic and a spell calculator for on-the-fly casting.

- **Let players pitch their skill.** Name the attribute, let the player say which skill they're bringing, then judge the fit honestly. A clever pitch deserves an Adjacent or Exact; a stretch is Relevant at best.
- **Call for the right save.** A cognitive trap is Resolve. A collapsing wall of flame is Dodge. A marathon climb up an icy cliff is Grit. Lean on the three saves rather than inventing new mechanics.
- **Use damage types.** Most characters armor up against Physical and Fire. Now and then, field a foe that deals Psychic, Acid or Force.
- **Track armor durability.** When armor breaks mid-fight, the stakes spike. The sheet does the math; make sure the player notices.
- **Reward smart spell building.** A caster who pays 5 EP to amp the DC is reading the odds. Tell them when it mattered.
- **Hold players to their tethers and flaws.** They were paid for in BP. If they never bite, bring them into the story.
- **Pace BP awards steadily.** 5–25 BP per session: the high end for a hard-won fight or a quest beat, the low end for quiet downtime. A new skill rank or attribute step should take a few sessions to earn.
- **Keep the tier fixed.** Grow characters with BP awards, never by raising the power tier mid-campaign.

Using rpg.jaeg.click

- **No account needed.** Anyone can create a character, open its sheet and edit it.
- **Builder**: steps through name, BP, HP/EP/speed, tethers and flaws, attributes, skills and magic, with a BP bar that warns when you're over budget.
- **Passcode**: when you create a character you can give it an optional passcode. Then only someone who enters it can view, edit or delete the character. Your browser remembers it after the first time.
- **Sheet**: tracks current HP, EP and temporary HP, takes typed damage and applies armor, runs death saves and long rests, holds your inventory, saved spells and saved maneuvers, and builds spells and maneuvers on the fly.
- **Deleting** a character without a passcode needs a signed-in account.

Quick Reference

Turns

4 actions, reset at the end of your turn
Unspent actions are reactions: one per other combatant's turn, any number per round
Default reactions: Parry (adjacent attacker), Move

Rolls

Check: d20 + attribute + skill vs DC
Attack: d20 + weapon skill + attribute vs Evasion
Spell attack: d20 + school + medium vs Evasion
Spell save DC: 10 + school + medium
Maneuver: d20 + skill + attribute; DC 10 + skill + attribute
Evasion: 10 + Agility + Dodge − armor

DCs

Easy 12 · Medium 20 · Hard 30 · Near-impossible 40

Fit: Negative ×1.5 · Relevant ×0.9 · Adjacent ×0.75 · Exact ×0.6

Criticals

Nat 20: +10 · Nat 1: −10
Crit success: beat DC by 10+
Crit failure: under 25% of DC

Costs

HP: 2 BP per 3 · EP: 2 BP each
Speed: 20 ft base, 5 ft steps

LV	SKILL	ATTR/SCHOOL	MEDIUM
1	2	13	8
2	5	34	21
3	10	68	42
4	18	123	76
5	31	212	131
6	52	356	220

Spell EP per tier

Range 4 · AOE 5 · Duration 4 · Buff/Debuff 5 · Challenge 8 · Damage die 2
Reaction ×4 · Action ×2 · 2 Actions ×1 · 1 Round ×0.75 · 1 Minute ×0.5 · 1 Hour ×0.25
Saved spell −25% · Amp: +1 per 5 EP